

Measuring Fix-It: Gaps and Overlaps

Directions:

- When we measure, the units must sit end to end — no gaps, no overlaps.
- Some kids in these problems measured the wrong way. Fix their counts!

1. The pencil is 8 cubes long. The crayon is 5 cubes long. How many cubes longer is the pencil than the crayon?

Answer: _____ cubes

2. Mia measured her ribbon twice with paper clips. When she left gaps between the clips she counted 6 clips. When the clips touched end to end she counted 9 clips.

- (a) How many clips did the gaps hide? _____
(b) Say which count is the ribbon's true length.

3. Leo measured the table with sticks, but he overlapped some sticks, so his count came out 2 sticks too many. Leo counted 10 sticks. Fix his count: how many sticks long is the table really? Tell what went wrong.

Answer: _____ sticks

4. Zoe measured the rope with paper clips but left 3 gaps, and each gap was exactly 1 clip of rope. Zoe counted only 4 clips. Fix her count: how many paper clips long is the rope really? Tell how you know.

Answer: _____ paper clips

5. The blue string is 11 clips long. The red string is 14 clips long. Write $>$, $<$, or $=$ in the blank:

11 _____ 14

6. Challenge! Kim measured the bench with blocks but overlapped some, so her count was 3 blocks too many. Kim counted 15 blocks. Ali measured the same bench with no overlaps and counted 12 blocks.

(a) Fix Kim's count: _____ blocks

(b) Say whether Kim and Ali now agree.